

INVITATIONS AND REPLIES

INVITATIONS

Invitations are of **two types**:

1. **Formal Invitations**
2. **Informal Invitations**

FORMAL INVITATIONS

Formal invitations are **polite, pleasant, courteous and written in a formal style**.

Types of Formal Invitations

1. Formal Invitation Card

- Printed invitation card.
- Used for public or family functions like weddings, inaugurations, anniversaries, exhibitions, etc.
- **Does NOT include the name of the addressee.**
- Written in the **third person**.

2. Formal Invitation Letter (to a VIP)

- Typed or handwritten letter.
- Addressed to a distinguished guest (Chief Guest/Guest of Honour/President).
- **The name of the addressee appears prominently.**
- Written in the **third person** and follows the format of a formal letter.

Features of Formal Invitations

A formal invitation should include:

- **Who** is inviting?
- **Whom** is the invitation for?
- **What** is the occasion?
- **When** will it be held?
- **Where** will it be held?
- **Time** of the event

Other details may include:

- Name/designation of the organiser
- Sponsor/host
- Chief Guest/Guest of Honour (if applicable)

- RSVP details

FORMAT

Sender's Address

_____ **Leave a line**

Date

_____ **Leave a line**

Receiver's Name

Receiver's Address

_____ **Leave a line**

Subject

_____ **Leave a line**

Salutation

_____ **Leave a line**

Body

- Purpose of invitation
- Date, time and venue
- Request to preside/grace the occasion
- Courteous closing

_____ **Leave a line**

Complimentary Close

Name

Designation

Sample Question

The Literary Club of your school is **staging the play ‘Waiting for Godot’**. As Secretary of the club, draft an invitation inviting the famous writer **Sudesh Gupta** to be the **Guest of Honour**. Write the invitation in about **50 words**.

Sample Answer

ABC School
Shastri Nagar
Mumbai - 560068

20 January 2027

Mr. Sudesh Gupta
PQR Colony
Mumbai - 560024

Subject: Invitation as Guest of Honour.

Sir

The Literary Club of our school is staging the play 'Waiting for Godot' on 27 January 2026 in the school auditorium from 9:00 a.m. to 10:00 a.m. On behalf of the club, I cordially invite you to grace the occasion as the Guest of Honour. We shall be honoured by your esteemed presence and look forward to your kind acceptance.

Yours truly
Gauri
Secretary, Literary Club

FORMAL INVITATION CARD

A formal invitation card is a printed invitation used for occasions such as inaugurations, weddings, anniversaries, exhibitions, cultural events and official functions. It is written in the third person and does not include the name of the addressee.

Essential Elements of a Formal Invitation Card

- Name of the Host/Organisation
- Standard invitation phrase (e.g., cordially invites you to...)
- Purpose of the invitation
- Name of the event/honouree (if applicable)
- Day, Date and Time
- Venue (complete address)
- RSVP
- Contact Number/Address

FORMAT

Name of the host

Standard expression

Purpose of the invitation

Name of the honouree

Day, date and time of the event

Name of the place, location with complete address

RSVP (please respond)

Telephone or mobile number or
address of the host

Sample Question

M/s Shyam Lal & Sons are opening a new general store, 'Galaxy Novelties', in Geetanjali Enclave, Dwarka, Delhi. The inauguration ceremony is fixed for Sunday, 19 October 20XX at 11:00 a.m. Draft a formal invitation card for the occasion.

Sample Answer

M/S SHYAM LAL & SONS announce the opening of GALAXY NOVELTIES a general store in Geetanjali Enclave, Dwarika, Delhi INAUGURATION on SUNDAY, THE 19TH OF OCTOBER, 20XX At 11 a.m. All are cordially invited Visit for all kinds of Grocery & Domestic items AVAIL INAUGURAL DISCOUNT OF 10% ON ALL GOODS R.S.V.P Galaxy Novelties Phone: 011-27543201
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INFORMAL INVITATIONS

Informal invitations are written to friends, relatives and close acquaintances. They are personal, warm and persuasive in tone and are written in the form of an informal letter.

Features of an Informal Invitation

- Written in the first person.
- Follows the informal letter format.
- The sender's address is written on the left-hand side.
- The date is mentioned below the address.
- The salutation is Dear + Name.
- The language is friendly, personal and persuasive.
- Different tenses may be used according to the context.
- The complimentary close may be:
 - Yours affectionately
 - Yours lovingly

FORMAT

Sender's Address

_____ **Leave a line**

Date

_____ **Leave a line**

Salutation

_____ **Leave a line**

Body

- Opening sentence (share the happy news)
- Details of the occasion (what, when, where)
- Extend the invitation warmly
- Express hope that the person will attend

_____ **Leave a line**

Complimentary Close

Name

Sample Question

You are Saniya. The wedding of your elder sister, Seema, is going to be held on 15 October 2026 at Hotel Lake View, Udaipur. Write an informal invitation to your friend Reena, requesting her to attend the wedding.

Sample Answer

4357, Vasant Kunj
Raj Nagar - 666783

1 October 2026

Dear Reena

I am delighted to share some wonderful news with you. My elder sister, Seema, is getting married on 15 October, 2026 at Hotel Lake View, Udaipur. The wedding ceremony will begin at 8:00 p.m., and we shall also have dinner together at the hotel. It would mean a lot to me if you could join us and bless the couple. I am eagerly looking forward to your presence on this joyous occasion.

Yours affectionately
Saniya

REPLIES TO INVITATIONS

Replies to invitations may be of two types:

1. Acceptance
2. Declining (Regret)

Formal Replies

Formal replies are written in the form of a formal letter. They should be brief, polite and courteous.

Features of a Formal Reply

- Follow the formal letter format.
- Mention the writer's address and date.
- Include a subject line.
- Use polite expressions such as:
 - Thank you for your kind invitation.
 - I am pleased to accept...
 - I regret my inability...
 - I feel honoured...
 - It will be a pleasure...
- If declining, mention the reason politely.
- End with an appropriate complimentary close such as 'Yours sincerely'.

FORMAT:

Writer's Address

_____ **Leave a line**

Date

_____ **Leave a line**

Receiver's Designation

Organisation

Address

_____ **Leave a line**

Subject

_____ **Leave a line**

Sir/Madam

_____ **Leave a line**

Body

- Thank the organiser for the invitation.
- State whether you accept or decline.
- Mention the reason (if declining).
- End politely.

_____ **Leave a line**

Yours truly

Name

Sample Question

You are Akshya/Aakriti. You have been invited to participate in a seminar on 'Fundamental Rights of Children' on 20 November 2026, organised by the Lions Club of your district. Write a formal reply accepting the invitation.

Sample Answer (Acceptance)

25, Aram Bagh Road

Meerut - 243677

5 November 2026

The Secretary

Lions Club

Meerut - 243577

Subject: Acceptance of Invitation.

Sir

Thank you for your kind invitation to participate in the seminar on 'Fundamental Rights of Children' on 20 November 2026. I appreciate your concern for the welfare of children and shall be delighted to participate in the programme. I hereby confirm my presence and look forward to interacting with the participants.

Yours truly
Akshya

Sample Answer (Declining)

25, Aram Bagh Road
Meerut - 243677

5 November 2026

The Secretary
Lions Club
Meerut - 243677

Subject: Inability to Accept the Invitation.

Sir

Thank you very much for your kind invitation to participate in the seminar on 'Fundamental Rights of Children' on 20 November 2026. I feel honoured to have been invited. However, due to a prior commitment, I regret my inability to attend the programme. I wish the seminar every success and thank you once again for your thoughtful invitation.

Yours truly
Akshya

PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. Informal Invitation

You are **Megha/Mohit**. Your **birthday** falls on **20 October**. Write an informal invitation to your friend Ritu, **inviting her to your birthday party at your residence**. Invent necessary details. (50 words)

2. Formal Reply (Acceptance with Time Constraint)

You are **Dr. Meera Kapoor**, a renowned artist. You have received an invitation from the **Art Society of Delhi** to inaugurate an **Art Exhibition** on **15 September 2026**. You are pleased to accept the invitation but can attend the function for only **half an hour** due to a prior engagement. Draft a **formal reply** accepting the invitation and mentioning your time constraint. (50 words)

3. Formal Invitation (VIP)

Your school has launched a **Mental Health Awareness Week** following increasing stress among students. As the Secretary of the Wellness Club, draft a formal invitation inviting a noted psychologist to deliver the inaugural address. Invent necessary details. (50 words)

4. Formal Reply (Decline Politely)

You are the Principal of a reputed school. You have been invited to inaugurate a **Career Guidance Fair**, but your school has been declared a centre for board examinations on the same day. Draft a formal reply expressing your inability to attend while appreciating the initiative. (50 words)

5. Informal Invitation

Your cousin has recently won a national scholarship. Your family has organised a surprise dinner to celebrate the achievement. Write an informal invitation to your friend requesting them to join the celebration. (50 words)

6. Formal Invitation Card

To reduce the use of plastic in your locality, your colony is organising a '**No Plastic Day**' **Campaign**. As the Secretary of the Residents' Welfare Association, draft a formal invitation card inviting residents to attend the event and pledge their support. Invent necessary details. (50 words)

7. Formal Reply (Acceptance)

You are a well-known author invited to address students on "**The Joy of Reading in the Digital Age**." Draft a formal reply accepting the invitation and expressing your appreciation for the theme of the programme. (50 words)

8. Formal Invitation (VIP)

Your school is celebrating the success of students who have represented India in international competitions. As the Head Boy/Head Girl, draft a formal invitation inviting an Olympic medal winner as the **Chief Guest** for the felicitation ceremony. Invent necessary details. (50 words)

9. Formal Reply (Decline with Alternative)

You have been invited to be the Guest of Honour at a **Science Exhibition**. Unfortunately, you will be travelling abroad on the scheduled date. Draft a formal reply declining the invitation while wishing the organisers success and expressing your willingness to visit the exhibition on another day. (50 words)

10. Formal Invitation Card

Your school noticed that very few parents attend school events. To encourage greater participation, the PTA has planned a **Family Interaction Day**. As the Secretary of the PTA, draft a formal invitation card inviting parents to attend. (50 words)